indeed strange that rulers in whose hands were Hindustan and Khurāsānāt[10] had not chosen it for their capital. In the Sulṭān's (Maḥmūd's) time there may have been three or four dams in the country; one he made, some three yīghāch (18 m) up the Ghaznī-water to the north; it was about 40-50 qārī (yards) high and some 300 long; through it, the stored waters were let out as required. It was destroyed by 'Alāu'u'd-dīn Jahān-soz Ghūrī when he conquered the country (AD 1152), burned and ruined the tombs of several descendants of Sulṭān Maḥmūd sacked and burned the town, in short, left undone no title of murder and rapine. Since that time, the Sulṭān's dam has lain in ruins, but, through God's favor, there is hope that it may become of use again, by means of the money which was sent, in Khwāja Kalān's hand, in the year Hindustan was conquered (AD 1526). The Sakhāndam is another, 2 or 3 yīghāch (12-18 m.), may-be, on the east of the town; it has long been in ruins, indeed is past repair. There is a dam in working order at Sar-i-dih (Village-head).Babur says in the *Baburnama*, 'in books, it is written that there is in Ghaznī a spring such that, if dirt and the foul matter be thrown into it, a tempest gets up instantly, with a blizzard of rain and wind. It has been seen said also in one of the histories that Sabuk-tīgīn, when besieged by the Rāī (Jāī-pāl) of Hind, ordered dirt and foulness to be thrown into the spring, by this aroused, in an instant, a tempest with the blizzard of rain and snow, and, by this device, drove off his foe. Though we made many inquiries, no intimation of the spring's existence was given us.'

In these countries, Ghaznī and Khwārizm were noted for cold, in the same way, that Sulṭānīā and Tabrīz were in the two 'Irāqs and Aẕarbāījān. Zurmut was another tūmān, some 12–13 yīghāch south of Kābul and 7–8 south-east of Ghaznī. Its dārogha's headquarters were in Gīrdīz; there, most houses were three or four storeys high. It did not want for strength and gave Nāṣir Mīrzā trouble when it went into hostility to him. Its people were Aūghān-shāl; they grew corn but had neither vineyards nor orchards. The tomb of Shaikh Muḥammad Muṣalmān was at a spring, high on the skirt of a mountain, known as Barakistān, in the south of the tūmān.

Farmūl used to be another tūmān, a humble place that grew not bad apples, which were then transported into Hindustan. The Shaikh-zādas, descendants of Shaikh Muḥammad Muṣalmān, who were highly regarded during the Afghān period in Hindustan, hailed from Farmūl.